

5. Ensures computer system and network reliability whether provided directly by the institution or through contractual arrangements.

The Technical Infrastructure Plan addresses computer system and network reliability, including power and data backups. The plan details cloud services, network agreements, and filtering.

6. Is evaluated annually (and revised as necessary).

The IT Committee annually evaluates the Technical Infrastructure Plan and revises it as necessary. The annual evaluation is intended to ensure the plan's purpose is met and the associated resources and infrastructure are functioning as intended. Changes to the plan are approved by the President's Cabinet, which consists of administration, faculty, and staff.

7. Ensures basic information about the plan is available to the administration, faculty, and staff. [See Section VII. Definitions – Plan]

The Technical Infrastructure Plan is available on Southwest Technical College's website.

8. The technology used by the institution to deliver services and, if applicable, program content to students meets the needs of the students without creating barriers to student support or learning.

Instructional and non-instructional equipment and supplies are used in accordance with manufacturer recommendations and standard practices.

As part of the regular schedule, the Information Technology department performs preventative maintenance and upgrades to the physical resources and technical infrastructure. In the case of highly technical maintenance, repairs, replacement, or disposal of non-instructional equipment and supplies, the work may be contracted with a qualified company.

In the case of specific program equipment (i.e., instructional equipment), the program director or faculty are the experts. In some cases, maintenance or repairs can be performed internally, while other situations may require outsourcing to technical experts. Each program has an equipment budget that is controlled by the program director. During the budgeting process, the program can make requests for the replacement, disposal, and/or upgrade of equipment.

Each department and program budgets for and purchases the supplies that are necessary for its operations. The Director of Information Technology develops an annual budget for IT support function supplies.

9. Procedures for preserving and protecting student coursework, testing, and records are provided by measures that ensure their preservation and protection.

Utilizing the SCALE (H3C) virtual environment, all mission-critical servers operate as a virtual environment. A secondary backup array is in one of the college's secondary campus locations, where a snapshot is taken and stored every 15 minutes. In the event of a server or